Aqa Riza but also some of the younger Mughal artists, the sons and nephews of some of the grandmasters of Akbar's court such as Manohar, the son of one of Akbar's favourite artists Basawan, and Govardhan, the son of Bhavani Das. There were also Mansur, Nadira Banu, Mirza Ghulam, Nanha, Bishen Das, and Quli, as also the calligrapher Mir Abdullah, and the illuminator, Lutfullah. Indeed, the most successful aspect of Salim's rebellion was possibly the wordless challenge he extended to his father through the luminous works of arts created at Allahabad.

One of the very first paintings created at Salim's court was eloquent in its symbolism. Created by Manohar and Mansur, this striking work, called 'Prince Salim Enthroned', showed no diffidence whatsoever in plainly painting the prince as a powerful monarch. It was painted in a style that self-consciously distanced itself from Akbar's court's Hindustani melange of vibrancy, dynamism, and colour. Moreover, whereas Akbar was always painted in the midst of historical moments teeming with animals and people, in this portrait Salim is conspicuously, and grandiosely, alone upon an elaborate throne. The painting itself is in a 'deliberately flat, ornamental, Persianate style' completely at odds with Akbar's Hindustani style, and art historian Milo Beach has pointed out that it also anticipates a number of spectacular portrait series painted after Salim had become Jahangir. This was an altogether different idea of kingship than that embraced by Akbar's paintings. In the *Akbarnama* paintings, the figure of Akbar is no doubt surrounded by a respectful space but the Padshah is always swept up and surrounded by other actors. Moreover, the painters of the *Akbarnama* gave as much tender attention to a dying animal's fear or a submissive courtier's contrition as to the Padshah himself. Salim, however, is remote, untouchable, and unfathomable, his majesty is distancing and awe-inspiring. Ironically, with his long, straight nose, his square jaw, and his almond-shaped eyes, it is Salim who is shown, almost inadvertently, as the unmistakable result of a Timurid–Hindustani alliance.

The apparatus of kingship in the image 'Prince Salim Enthroned' is unmistakable. About the massive and intricately carved coronation throne, Kavita Singh writes that Salim 'was likely to have been delighted by this elaborate and outsize royal seat whose gold and lapis lazuli ornamentation perhaps mimicked on paper the materials that may have adorned the rebel prince's actual bejeweled throne'. There were minute and potent symbols in the image, 'the lion victorious in hunt, the mythical simurgh, and the falcon